Class 2 Reading Homework

Era 1: Indigenous America (to 1491) · Focus: Pre-Columbian societies · environment & culture

Reading due today: AMSCO 1.1, 1.2

Connect: You start the year before 1492. As you read, notice how geography and climate shaped very different Indigenous societies — a theme (environment shaping development) you'll use all year.

Learning Objective(s) for today

– **1.2 (LO B):** Explain how and why various native populations in the period before European contact interacted with the natural environment in North America.

As you read, identify each of the following:

Terms (define in 1–2 sentences)

- [ ] maize cultivation
- [ ] Pueblo
- [ ] Mississippian (Cahokia)
- [ ] Great Plains nomads
- [ ] Iroquois Confederacy
- [ ] Three Sisters agriculture
- [ ] kinship networks

People (name + role/significance in 1 sentence)

- [ ] (regional cultures) Ancestral Pueblo
- [ ] Chinookan
- [ ] Iroquois
- [ ] Aztec/Mexica

Events (year + one-sentence significance)

- [ ] rise of Cahokia
- [ ] spread of maize north
- [ ] development of complex societies before contact

Reading Focus Questions

Answer in 2–4 complete sentences each. Use specific evidence from the reading.

1. Choose TWO Indigenous societies from different regions (e.g., Pueblo, Mississippian, Iroquois, Great Plains). How did each adapt to its natural environment?

2. What was the significance of maize (corn) cultivation for the development of complex societies in the Americas?

3. How did agriculture shape the way Iroquois society was organized before European contact?